PAPER BROS

# English Language Practice Workbook

## PAPER 1 READING · MARK SCHEMES

**20 Mark Schemes**

Cambridge O Level English Language 1123 format · Time allowed: 2 hours each

Preview

**Prepared by PaperBros**

Original practice material in the format of Cambridge O Level English Language 1123. Not an official Cambridge publication.

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Each mark scheme gives the accepted answers, guidance for examiners and the level tables for the summary and short response.


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# Marking guidance for all papers

## General marking principles

1 Award marks for each response in line with the specific content in the mark scheme, the skills defined in the mark scheme or level descriptions, and the standard of response the mark scheme describes.
2 Award whole marks only – never half marks or other fractions.
3 Mark positively. Marks are not deducted for errors or omissions. Credit correct answers that are worded differently from the mark scheme, and valid answers that go beyond it. Spelling, punctuation and grammar are judged only where the question says so, but the meaning of every answer must be clear.
4 Apply the mark scheme consistently, including the rules for responses that do not follow the instructions.
5 Use the full range of marks available.
6 Award marks according to the mark scheme, not with grade boundaries in mind.

## Point-based marking (Questions 1 and 2)

- **DO** credit answers that are worded differently from the mark scheme if they clearly convey the same meaning.
- **DO** credit alternative correct answers or examples which are not listed.
- **DO** credit more than one correct answer written in a single answer space where the question asks for a number of points.
- **DO NOT** credit an answer simply for repeating a key word from the text or the question – look for evidence of understanding.
- **DO NOT** credit answers which contradict themselves or try to cover every possibility.
- **DO NOT** credit the same point twice, including ‘mirror’ statements (e.g. noisy / not quiet).
- **DO NOT** require correct spelling unless meaning is lost.

Questions which say **using your own words** require candidates to show understanding by rephrasing key words; answers which simply lift the words of the text do not score.

## How to mark Question 3(a): the summary (20 marks: 10 Reading + 10 Writing)

**Reading (Table R, out of 10)**

- Place a tick for each relevant content point that is **fully** made, whether in the candidate’s own words or the words of the text. Copying is dealt with in the Writing mark, not the Reading mark.
- Use the indicative content in each paper’s mark scheme. Candidates do not have to use the same words, but the idea must be there.
- Do not credit the same point twice. Do not credit points which do not answer the question set (e.g. disadvantages when the question asks for benefits).
- The number of points made is normally the Reading mark (maximum 10). A summary with no fully made points may still reach Level 1 if some ideas are referred to.

**Writing (Table W, out of 10)**

- Identify stretches of text that have been copied. Do not count small slips (a wrong verb ending or missing article) as rewording, and do not ‘blanket’ penalise a whole section unless it really is copied.
- Reward original, accurate structures – relative clauses (who, which, where), subordinating conjunctions (although, since, as, whereas), ‘not only … but also’ – which make the summary fluent. Simple joining words (and, so) are not enough on their own.
- Reward precise own-word vocabulary and good substitutions (e.g. ‘leisure time’ for ‘free time’). Ornate or obscure vocabulary is not credited.
- Consider organisation: how ideas are grouped and linked so that the summary flows. Inappropriate phrases such as ‘in a nutshell’ or ‘moving on’ are not credited.
- A summary at Levels 4–5 has little or no copying and a good number of creditworthy own-word structures and vocabulary choices.

**Length and form**

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- Summaries should be no more than 150 words, but there is no automatic deduction for exceeding this. Very short answers are unlikely to show enough organisation or own words for the higher Writing levels.
- If the response is in note form throughout, award 0 for Writing but mark Reading as normal. Bulleted sentences are marked as normal.
- Reading and Writing assess different skills: a summary with a low Reading mark can still achieve a high Writing mark, and vice versa.

### How to mark Question 3(b): the short response (5 marks)

- Look for a consistent perspective that matches the character named in the question.
- Tick each relevant idea or detail taken from the text that supports that perspective (left-hand column in each mark scheme).
- Award DEV where an idea is developed through inference or expansion (right-hand column). Developments listed are examples; credit other sensible inferences.
- Use Table R (out of 5): Level 3 (4–5) requires a consistent perspective with ideas that are both supported and developed.

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# O Level Practice Paper

**ENGLISH LANGUAGE** **1123/01**

Paper 1 Reading **Practice Paper 01**

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 50

**Practice Mark Scheme**

This mark scheme contains the instructions and marking guidance for PaperBros Practice Paper 01. It follows the structure, assessment objectives and marking conventions of the Cambridge O Level English Language (1123) Paper 1 Reading syllabus.

Examiners should award marks positively for answers that meet the requirements set out below. Alternative answers which clearly convey the same meaning as an answer in the mark scheme should be credited.

General marking principles, together with full guidance on how to mark the Question 3(a) summary, are printed once at the front of this book and apply to every paper.

Preview

This document consists of 12 printed pages.

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